



AE9Labs: The Zero-SaaS Tech Stack Blueprint

How to build, deploy, and automate a digital storefront with \$0/month in fixed software fees.

Most modern gurus will tell you that to launch a digital product business, you need to cough up \$99/month for Shopify, \$149/month for Kajabi, and \$49/month for Zapier.

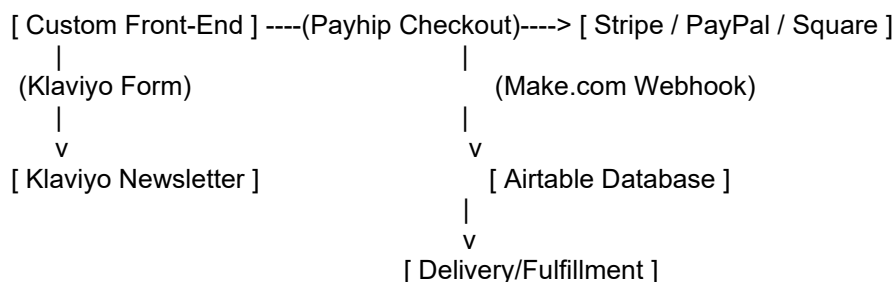
They are wrong.

By leveraging modern developer-focused free tiers, secure payment processors, and clean automation pipelines, you can run a highly professional, automated digital product empire with **exactly \$0.00 in fixed monthly software costs**. You only pay standard transaction fees when you make a sale.

Here is the exact blueprint we use to build, host, and automate our systems.



The Zero-SaaS System Architecture



The Infrastructure Stack

Tool	Purpose	Cost	Why We Use It
HTML5 / CSS3 / JS	Front-end Storefront	\$0 (Open Source)	Complete creative freedom. No restrictive platform templates.
GitHub Pages, Vercel, or Netlify	High-speed Cloud Hosting	\$0 (Free Tier)	Host your website entirely for free directly from your GitHub repository, or deploy to Vercel/Netlify with global CDN speeds.

Tool	Purpose	Cost	Why We Use It
Payhip	Checkout & Digital Delivery	\$0 (No monthly fee, 5% per transaction)	Handles PDF delivery, EU VAT, and plugs directly into your custom HTML site. Supports Stripe, PayPal, and Square.
Airtable	Backend Inventory & Order Log	\$0 (Free Tier)	Act as your custom relational database without the complexity of managing SQL servers.
Make.com	Workflow Automation	\$0 (Free Tier - 1,000 operations/mo)	The system glue. Instantly syncs checkout webhooks to your database.
Klaviyo	Email Marketing & Newsletters	\$0 (Free Tier - up to 250 contacts)	High-converting popup forms, automated welcome flows, and newsletter broadcasts.



Step-by-Step Deployment Guide

Phase 1: The Front-End & Free Hosting (Your Digital Real Estate)

Instead of renting a clunky page builder, write a clean, single-page static site and host it completely free.

1. Create a free **GitHub** account and commit your code to a repository.
2. **Host directly from GitHub:** Turn on **GitHub Pages** in your repository settings to launch your website instantly, straight from your repository, with zero external hosting setup.
3. *Alternative:* Link your GitHub repository to **Vercel** or **Netlify** for advanced global CDN performance.
4. Point your custom domain (the only thing you should ever pay for—about \$10/year) to your GitHub Pages, Vercel, or Netlify project. Your site is now live with 100% uptime and blazing-fast load speeds.

Phase 2: Checkout & Vaulting

To keep fixed costs at zero, use a pay-as-you-grow checkout engine.

1. Create a free **Payhip** account and link your **Stripe, PayPal, or Square** merchant account.
2. Upload your digital downloads, journals, or code templates.
3. Generate direct "Add to Cart" or "Buy Now" checkout buttons.
4. Embed those Payhip links directly into the custom HTML buttons on your website.

Phase 3: The Automated Delivery Pipe

Use automated webhooks to log customer data and keep your records immaculate without lifting a finger.

1. Set up a free **Airtable** base with columns for: *Customer Name, Email, Product Purchased, Order ID, and Date*.
2. Create a free **Make.com** account.
3. Build a 2-step scenario:
 - **Trigger:** *Webhooks* (Catch a Hook from Payhip when a sale occurs).
 - **Action:** *Airtable* (Create a Record in your customer database).
4. Now, every single transaction is instantly documented in your private database in real-time.

Phase 4: The Audience Engine

Capturing emails is how you build a long-term asset.

1. Design a clean, high-contrast, dual-card popup inside **Klaviyo**.
2. Embed the Klaviyo Onsite Javascript snippet right into your website's codebase before the closing `</body>` tag.
3. Create an automated **Welcome Flow** triggered when someone joins your newsletter list to instantly deliver this blueprint.



The Golden Rules of Zero-SaaS Operations

- **Rule 1: If it can be static, make it static.** Don't use heavy database-driven CMS platforms like WordPress. Pure HTML/CSS hosted on GitHub Pages loads instantly and is virtually unhackable.
- **Rule 2: Build behind the scenes.** Spend your time perfecting your code, design templates, and delivery pipelines rather than chasing platform-specific trends.
- **Rule 3: Bootstrap the beginning.** Do not upgrade to paid software tiers until your storefront's organic revenue easily covers the cost. Let your customers fund your infrastructure upgrades.

⚡ **System Active. Now Go Build.**

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